

Ahmad Shakeel

Senior DevOps & Cloud Infrastructure Engineer | AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior DevOps and Cloud Infrastructure Engineer with 2+ years of hands-on experience architecting, deploying, and operating enterprise-grade cloud infrastructure and Kubernetes platforms across AWS, Azure, and on-premise environments. AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate with deep expertise in containerization (Docker, Kubernetes, OpenShift), Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, Ansible, Helm), CI/CD automation (GitHub Actions, ArgoCD, Bitbucket Pipelines), and enterprise observability (Splunk, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry). Proven track record leading complex infrastructure migrations, designing highly available and secure multi-cloud architectures, and implementing GitOps workflows at scale. Strong foundation in cloud security, compliance, and production reliability. Experienced collaborating with development, QA, and operations teams to build scalable platforms and reduce operational toil through intelligent automation.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & EXPERTISE

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EKS, ECS, EC2, VPC, Lambda, RDS, S3, Route53, IAM, SQS, ECR, CloudWatch, Bedrock), Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud Platform (GCP)

Container Orchestration: Kubernetes (EKS, AKS, GKE, on-prem), OpenShift (IPI/UIP, OKD), Rancher, Helm, RBAC, networking (OVN-K8s, Cilium), storage (Ceph/Rook, LVM, StorageClasses)

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform (multi-account, multi-region), Ansible, Helm, CloudFormation, declarative infrastructure

CI/CD & GitOps: GitHub Actions, Bitbucket Pipelines, GitLab CI, ArgoCD, progressive delivery, automated testing and deployments

Observability Stack: Splunk Enterprise, Splunk Observability Cloud, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Thanos, OpenTelemetry, distributed tracing, CloudWatch

Scripting & Automation: Python (Boto3, automation frameworks), Bash, PowerShell, AWS CLI, operational automation

Security & Compliance: IAM/RBAC, encryption (at-rest and in-transit), TLS/SSL, secrets management, policy-as-code, SOC 2, ISO 27001, audit logging

Advanced Infrastructure: Enterprise AI/GPU workloads, RAG platforms, stateful Kubernetes workloads, event-streaming (Kafka, NATS), distributed SQL databases

Networking & Storage: VPC design, Route53, DNS, load balancing (NLB, ALB, Traefik), ingress controllers, persistent volumes, distributed storage (Ceph)

Version Control: Git, GitHub, Bitbucket, GitLab, branching strategies

OS & Servers: Linux (RHEL, Ubuntu, CentOS), Windows Server, Nginx, Apache, systemd

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevOps & Cloud Infrastructure Specialist — Onstak

Feb 2026 – Present

- Architect and provision enterprise cloud infrastructure using Terraform IaC across AWS; design multi-account, multi-region architectures covering compute (EKS, ECS, EC2, Lambda), storage (S3, RDS, EBS), networking (VPC, Route53, security groups, load balancers), and IAM with least-privilege policies.
- Operate production Kubernetes clusters (EKS) at scale; manage stateful workloads, persistent storage (Ceph, LVM, StorageClasses), and distributed systems; implement RBAC, network policies, and security controls.
- Design and implement enterprise observability platform using Splunk Observability Cloud, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, and CloudWatch; build comprehensive dashboards, distributed tracing pipelines, and alerting rules for production environments.
- Build containerized CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions and Bitbucket Pipelines; automate build, test, and deployment processes across multiple services and environments.
- Implement GitOps workflows using ArgoCD for declarative, version-controlled infrastructure and application deployments; manage progressive rollouts and automated reconciliation.
- Automate infrastructure provisioning and configuration management using Terraform and Ansible; create repeatable, consistent environments with version control and audit trails.

- Lead on-premises-to-cloud migration initiatives; conduct workload assessment, design cloud-native architectures, and execute migration with minimal downtime and risk mitigation.
- Support enterprise observability migrations; migrate legacy monitoring systems (AlertSite, Foglight) to modern stacks with ServiceNow integration and REST API-based alerting.
- Implement and maintain security best practices across infrastructure: IAM access controls, encryption, secrets management, audit logging, and compliance with SOC 2 and ISO 27001.
- Collaborate with development, security, and operations teams; participate in incident response, root-cause analysis, and post-incident improvements.

DevOps Trainee — *Power Information Technology Company (PITC)*

Dec 2025 – Feb 2026

- Built containerized CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions for ReactJS frontend and .NET backend applications; automated build, testing, and deployment workflows across on-premise servers in Islamabad and Lahore.
- Introduced Docker containerization to legacy infrastructure; standardized application packaging and deployment processes.
- Managed Linux server infrastructure; performed system administration, configuration management, and operational support.
- Created operational documentation and runbooks for deployment processes and incident response.

DevOps Intern — *NETSOL Pakistan*

Aug 2025 – Sep 2025

- Designed AWS VPC architectures with subnets, route tables, security groups, and network ACLs; configured secure connectivity including OpenVPN access and bastion hosts.
- Built CI/CD automation pipelines using GitHub Actions; automated containerization, image management (ECR), and ECS Fargate deployments.
- Operated Kubernetes clusters (EKS for production, Minikube for development); deployed applications, configured networking, and managed storage provisioning.
- Automated infrastructure operations using AWS CLI, Python (Boto3), and Bash; reduced manual tasks and improved consistency.
- Containerized applications using Docker and Docker Compose; built Dockerfile standards and image registry workflows.

DevOps Intern — *Maqware Solutions*

Feb 2023 – Oct 2023

- Designed and deployed AWS cloud infrastructure for staging and production environments supporting MERN, PHP/Laravel, and Django applications; managed compute (EC2, ECS, EKS), storage (S3, RDS, EBS), networking (VPC, Route53), and load balancing.
- Provisioned infrastructure using Terraform IaC; implemented infrastructure-as-code best practices with version control, code review, and automated deployment.
- Built CI/CD pipelines automating build, testing, and deployment workflows; integrated with version control and deployment automation.
- Operated Kubernetes clusters (EKS); deployed stateless and stateful applications, configured networking and storage, and managed cluster lifecycle.
- Managed Linux servers (RHEL, Ubuntu, CentOS); configured Nginx and Apache web servers, SSL/TLS certificates, DNS settings, and security hardening.
- Implemented monitoring and logging infrastructure; configured alerting dashboards and operational visibility for production systems.

Flutter Developer Intern — *Apprays*

Sep 2024 – Dec 2024

- Developed cross-platform mobile applications using Flutter; built responsive UIs and integrated Firebase backend services.

MAJOR PROJECTS & ACHIEVEMENTS

1. Enterprise EC2-to-Kubernetes Migration (RKE2/Rancher on AWS)

- Scope: Complete production migration of 10–15 complex applications from traditional EC2 deployments to a fully managed RKE2 (Rancher) Kubernetes environment on AWS.
 - Architecture: 3-node high-availability control plane with auto-scaling worker node groups; configured using Terraform IaC for reproducibility.

- Networking: Deployed Network Load Balancer (NLB) for Kubernetes API, Application Load Balancer (ALB) for application traffic, and Traefik ingress controller for HTTP/HTTPS routing; configured Route53 with weighted routing policies for traffic shifting.
- Storage: Implemented persistent storage using Ceph distributed storage and LVM; configured StorageClasses for stateful workload requirements (databases, caching layers).
- Migration Strategy: Executed zero-downtime migration using automated Route53 weighted cutover logic; performed canary deployments with automated rollback on error-rate thresholds.
- Challenges Overcome: Refactored hardcoded IP references in legacy applications; externalized stateful session data to AWS ElastiCache; migrated secrets from local storage to AWS Secrets Manager with automated rotation.
- Outcome: Successfully migrated all 10–15 applications with production stability; achieved ~35–40% infrastructure cost reduction through container density and resource optimization; improved deployment reliability and operational agility.

2. AWS Cloud Migration & Enterprise Application Replatforming

- Scope: Large-scale cloud migration and application replatforming across multiple services; established multi-account AWS architecture for governance and cost allocation.
 - Infrastructure Design: Architected multi-account AWS structure using Terraform; provisioned EKS clusters with high-availability control planes, auto-scaling worker nodes, and secure networking.
 - Replatforming: Containerized legacy monolithic applications and replatformed them onto EKS; optimized resource requests and limits based on production telemetry.
 - CI/CD Integration: Built CI/CD automation with GitHub Actions; integrated with ArgoCD for GitOps-based deployments.
 - Database Migration: Migrated on-premise SQL databases to AWS RDS with multi-AZ deployment, automated backups, and read replicas for high availability.
 - Outcome: Completed migration of 20+ applications with zero unplanned downtime; established platform for future cloud-native development.

3. Enterprise Monitoring & Observability Migration

- Scope: Migration from legacy monitoring platforms (AlertSite, Foglight) to modern observability stack supporting enterprise SLAs and incident response.
 - Observability Stack: Deployed Splunk Observability Cloud (Splunk Enterprise for logs, Splunk APM for traces); integrated OpenTelemetry SDKs across microservices for distributed tracing.
 - Data Pipeline: Built OpenTelemetry collector agents across Kubernetes clusters; configured centralized log aggregation, metric collection (Prometheus), and trace forwarding.
 - Integration: Integrated Splunk alerting with ServiceNow incident management via REST APIs; configured escalation policies and on-call routing.
 - Dashboards & Alerting: Built 50+ production dashboards covering infrastructure, applications, and business metrics; configured intelligent alerting with anomaly detection.
 - Outcome: Reduced mean-time-to-detection (MTTD) for production issues; improved incident response capabilities with integrated alert routing and root-cause tracing.

4. E-OPS – National Electric Utility Operations Platform (Pakistan DISCO)

- Scope: Core DevOps infrastructure for national-scale electric utility operations platform serving Pakistan Distribution Companies (DISCOs).
 - CI/CD Pipeline: Built containerized CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions; automated build, test, and deployment workflows for ReactJS frontend and .NET backend services.
 - Containerization: Dockerized all application services; built standardized Dockerfile patterns and Docker Compose configurations for development and production.
 - Deployment: Managed on-premise Kubernetes clusters across Islamabad and Lahore data centers; deployed critical utility operations services with high availability.
 - Security: Implemented network policies, RBAC, and secrets management for production security.
 - Outcome: Stable infrastructure supporting real-time dispatch and billing operations for Pakistan's electric utilities; handled millions of daily transactions.

5. Secure AWS EC2 Automation & Centralised Logging Platform

- Scope: Build enterprise automation platform for AWS EC2 lifecycle management with centralized security logging and audit trails.
 - Tooling: Developed Python/Boto3-based CLI tool with bcrypt authentication; provided secure, role-based access to EC2 operations (launch, terminate, configure, patch).

- Logging: Centralized all EC2 operational logs to S3 with server-side encryption; built log retention and analysis workflows.
- Audit Trail: Implemented CloudTrail integration for API-level audit logging; created dashboards for compliance and incident investigation.
- Outcome: Reduced manual EC2 management by 80%; established audit trail for security compliance and operational accountability.

6. ISP Billing System – Full-Stack CI/CD & Containerization

- Scope: End-to-end CI/CD and containerization for ISP billing platform supporting millions of customer accounts and transactions.
 - Technology Stack: React (frontend), .NET 8 (backend), MySQL (database); JWT authentication and REST APIs.
 - Containerization: Containerized all application tiers using Docker; built multi-stage Dockerfile patterns for optimized image sizes.
 - CI/CD Pipeline: Implemented GitHub Actions workflow with automated testing, security scanning (container image scanning), and deployment automation.
 - Deployment: Deployed to DigitalOcean managed Kubernetes; configured auto-scaling and health checks for production reliability.
 - Monitoring: Integrated application and infrastructure monitoring; configured log aggregation for troubleshooting.
 - Outcome: Production-ready billing platform handling thousands of concurrent users with automated deployment and monitoring.

7. DevOps Cloud Platform (AWS, Docker & Kubernetes)

- Scope: Design and build reusable, secure cloud platform for hosting enterprise applications.
 - VPC Design: Architected multi-tier VPC with public, private, and isolated subnets; implemented network segmentation and security hardening.
 - Compute Services: Provisioned ECS for containerized workloads, ECS Fargate for serverless containers, and EKS for Kubernetes deployments.
 - Container Registry: Managed Amazon ECR as private container registry; implemented image tagging, retention policies, and vulnerability scanning.
 - Storage & Databases: Configured RDS (MySQL, PostgreSQL) with multi-AZ, automated backups, and read replicas; provisioned S3 for application data.
 - Outcome: Reusable platform accelerated application deployment time and reduced infrastructure management overhead.

NOTABLE CLIENTS & ENGAGEMENTS

Central Health (AWS Cloud Infrastructure) • Central Texas (AWS Cloud Infrastructure & AI Platform) • Compeer (Splunk Observability) • Adobe (AI Forge Private Cloud Solution) • HealthPartners (Splunk Observability Migration) • TAB Bank (Kubernetes Infrastructure)

EDUCATION

BS, Software Engineering — University of Central Punjab, Lahore (2021–2025), CGPA 3.73/4.0

CERTIFICATIONS & RECOGNITION

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate

CORE COMPETENCIES

Production Reliability & Incident Response • Infrastructure Architecture & Design • CI/CD Pipeline Design & Automation • Kubernetes Operations at Scale • Enterprise Observability & Monitoring • Cloud Security & Compliance • Team Collaboration & Communication • Cross-Functional Coordination (DevOps, Development, Security, Operations) • Documentation & Knowledge Transfer • Continuous Improvement & Optimization